



Tips & Tricks



Listing running processes

You can list/view every process by memory and/or CPU on your system, using any of the following commands:

```
ps -ef
ps -e
ps -eF
ps -ely
```

List the total number of processes in a hierarchy:

```
ps -e -o pid,args --forest
```

List the processes by percentage of CPU usage:

```
ps -e -o pcpu,cpu,nice,state,cputime,args --sort pcpu | sed '/^ 0.0 /d'
```

List processes on the basis of memory usage:

```
ps -e -o rss=,args= | sort -b -k1,in | pr -TW$COLUMNS
```

List all threads for a particular process (for example, *firefox-bin*):

```
ps -C firefox-bin -l -o pid,tid,pcpu,state
```

List information for particular PIDs:

```
ps -p 1,2
```

List paths that the PID has opened:

```
lsop -p $$
```

— Shreyas Parikh, shreyas-parikh@hotmail.com



DNS cache cleaning

There is a simple command to quickly clean the DNS cache for every OS. On Linux, make sure you have the *nscd* tool installed and running in the background as a daemon. In order to clear the DNS cache, simply restart the daemon as follows—you need root privileges:

```
/etc/init.d/nscd restart
```

— Riju, rijus@gmail.com



Handling the command prompt in a smart way

Working on the command prompt is an essential task for any Linux systems administrator. However, many newcomers find it difficult to use the Bash prompt. Here are some tricks to speed up your work.

(I) Recall the last argument from the previous command to save time: *ALT+.* (hold down the ALT key and press the dot). For example, let's assume you created a new directory as follows:

```
mkdir -p /tmp/demo/software/qtapp
```

Now you would like to change the directory to */tmp/demo/software/qtapp*. So type *cd* and press *ALT+.* and see how Bash copies the argument that you gave to the previous command—in your case, it's the path you provided to *mkdir*.

(II) Shortcut keys for command editing:

- CTRL+l : Clears the screen
- CTRL+u : Deletes the entire line
- CTRL+k : Deletes to the end of the line from the current cursor position
- CTRL+c : Cancels the command
- CTRL+z : Suspends the command